

TRAVIS HOKI

Senior Software Engineer

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Senior Full-Stack Engineer | ClassDojo

Dear Hiring Manager,

My son's charter school used ClassDojo. The photos his teacher shared were the only window I had into his school day, seeing him in his classroom in the middle of activities I would otherwise have missed. I would like to help build a product I have already used and believe in, one whose whole job is connecting teachers with families.

Why I think ClassDojo is awesome!

You describe the work as helping teachers and families share kids' most important learning moments, in school and at home. That is what I experienced from my side as the parent. Doing that for 45 million children across 180 countries, in 95% of US schools, means the software has to work for people who never chose it, cannot debug it, and are on whatever device the school happens to have. Building for an audience that cannot route around your mistakes is a harder constraint than most products face, and it is the part of the work I would find most interesting.

Why you should think I am awesome!

In my 14 years of experience I have built web applications at very different scales: small teams where I owned the full stack, high-traffic retail at Overstock, and Spiff, a startup I joined early and stayed with through its acquisition by Salesforce. We kept shipping the product there while meeting the engineering standards of a much larger company. Full-stack is where I started, with PHP on MySQL at Enspark, where I rebuilt the learning management system, and then Python and Django on PostgreSQL at Room Choice. Since then I have specialized in frontend infrastructure and engineering standards: raising test coverage, building tooling that found dead code and enforced lint rules, driving TypeScript adoption company-wide, and modernizing legacy code for performance. Code that is heavily tested and deployed daily is the environment I have spent years helping teams reach.

Why we would be awesome together!

Three things in the posting stood out. You promote pair programming, and mentoring through pairing has been the most satisfying part of my recent roles. You want engineers curious about AI-powered engineering done responsibly, and I use Claude Code and Cursor daily in production work. Third, I studied animation before I moved into software and still illustrate children's books. I would rather build somewhere that treats craft and personality as part of the product, which your branding and motion design clearly do. I would more than welcome the chance to talk.

Sincerely,
Travis Hoki